

are Jeshua and Zerubbabel. The last portion of his narrative preceding the interpolated matter is 2:1-14 (= Ezra, chap. 1). In this he had told of the proclamation of King Cyrus, and how the Jews prepared to obey it; then, further, how the king brought out the sacred vessels belonging to the temple in Jerusalem (which are fully described and numbered), and delivered them into the hand of a Jewish prince named Sheshbazzar. At this point the narrative is interrupted by the interpolation. The next portion of the history which is certainly known to come from the hand of the Chronicler is the list, 5:7-42 (= Ezra 2:1-67), and where the narrative is resumed at the close of the list it appears that the returning exiles are already in Jerusalem. This is a surprising leap, especially for such a narrator as the Chronicler. We should certainly expect him to describe, with some detail, the starting of the expedition; to make express mention of the two leaders, Jeshua and Zerubbabel, whom he elsewhere makes so prominent; to tell of the provision made by the king—and afterward referred to—for the aid of the Jews and especially for the building of the temple; and so on.⁸ The probability at once suggests itself, that a part of the Chronicler's narrative is contained in the long sequel to the Story of the Three Youths, that is, in the section 4:43—5:6.

It would, of course, be the wish of the interpolator to use the original narrative as far as possible; and in this case that would be especially easy, since all the circumstances, and even the names (excepting only the name of the king), are identical. This probability becomes much stronger as soon as we observe the peculiar way in which the expansion of the Story has been effected. As was remarked above, it has been left absolutely untouched—saving the gloss of two words in 4:13—all the way from the beginning, 3:1, to 4:42, which is evidently the last verse of the original story which we have. It would have been an easy matter, and, we should say, most desirable, to add a bit of Jewish coloring, especially at the beginning, if only in order to make the connection more plausible. But the redactor took his task very easily, and apparently limited his own editorial additions to what was absolutely necessary. In view of this, it is surprising to find that the extra-canonical matter constituting the sequel to the Story occupies twenty-seven verses—about half the extent of the

⁸See my brief statement of the case in the *Journal of Biblical Literature*, 1897 pp. 168-70.